

# Gauntlet v0.6.3 Reference Guide

**Status:** Release candidate — not published

**Version:** v0.6.3

## Setup

**Faction setup → Draw 4 / discard 1 / keep 3 → arrange Territories → form and reveal Gauntlet → place tokens → roll first player**

- Shuffle the remaining Deck to form the Draw Pile after faction setup.
- Arrange Territories with the opening Hand and face-up opening discard known.
- Each token starts on the Territory at its player's own end; setup placement is neither movement nor entering.
- Roll for first player only after both players complete opening selection and Territory arrangement.

---

## Run the Gauntlet

Win immediately by either:

- capturing the Territory at your opponent's end; or
- winning your opponent's Last Stand.

After forcing the opponent beyond their end, a **separate legal movement sequence** may Advance beyond the Gauntlet and initiate the Last Stand. You do not need to control the final Territory first.

---

## Your Turn

**Capture → Draw → Opening → Movement → Denouement → Cleanup**

### Capture

If your token is beyond your **Front Line**, capture the next opposing Territory immediately beyond that line.

- Your controlled Territories must remain contiguous from your own end.
- Your position may extend beyond your control.
- Normal Capture advances your Front Line by at most one Territory per turn.

### Draw

Draw one card.

### Opening

You may take your Action now.

## Movement

Choose one:

- **Advance:** move one position toward the opponent's end.
- **Hold:** remain where you are.
- **Fall Back:** move one position toward your own end.

Entering the opponent's position creates a pending battle and ends the current movement sequence.

## Denouement

You may take your Action now if you did not take it during Opening.

## Cleanup

Resolve end-of-turn effects and discard down to the Hand limit. Pass the active-player marker.

---

## Card use reminder

Cards may print **Action**, **Asset**, **Gambit**, **Tactic**, or **Gambit/Tactic** effects. A card with an Asset effect has an inherent Bank Action unless it prints a special banking procedure.

## Actions

Each turn, normally take **one Action** during either Opening or Denouement.

An Action may:

- play one card for its **Action** effect;
- bank one card from Hand using its inherent **Bank** Action if it has an Asset effect;
- take one legal **Faction Action**; or
- discard one of your Assets.

Normally take no more than one Action during either phase.

An additional Action does not by itself permit two Actions during the same phase.

A **Faction Action** lists the phase in which it is legal.

A **Faction Ability** occurs at its stated timing and does not use an Action unless it says otherwise.

---

## Pending Battle and Terms

**Pending battle → Terms → Onset → Gambits**

Before Onset:

1. establish the attacker, defender, contested position, and the attacker's previous position;
2. resolve the Terms timing if a Diplomat is involved; and
3. proceed according to the decision.

## Accepted Terms

Apply the Proposal's Accepted effect. No battle begins.

Unless the Proposal says otherwise:

**The attacker withdraws. The defender remains at the contested position.**

No Onset, Gambit, Reserve, Tactic, Outcome, or Aftermath occurs.

## Refused or no Terms

Proceed to **Onset**.

---

# Battle

**Onset → set Gambits → form Reserves → reveal Gambits → choose Tactics → reveal Tactics → Outcome → Aftermath**

## Onset

Onset begins the battle. Resolve Onset effects before Gambits are set.

## Outcome

The higher battle total wins.

## Defensive Edge

**Defensive Edge: When the defender has Defensive Edge, the defender wins tied battle totals.**

The defender normally has Defensive Edge when:

- the defender controls the contested Territory; or
- the defender is making a Last Stand.

An effect may remove Defensive Edge, including an applicable Arena Territory effect.

## Tiebreak Roll

If the tie remains unresolved:

**Each player rolls one die. Do not apply advantage, disadvantage, card effects, numerical modifiers, or the previous battle totals. Higher roll wins. Reroll further ties.**

Only an effect that expressly refers to a **Tiebreak Roll** may modify it.

---

# Retreat and Withdrawal

**A losing player retreats; a player who leaves without losing withdraws.**

Retreat and withdrawal normally move a player the same way:

- attacker: return to the position from which they entered;
- defender: move one position toward their own end;
- only the attacker withdraws: the defender remains in the contested position;
- only the defender withdraws: the attacker remains in the contested position and becomes the occupier when applicable;

- both withdraw: move the attacker first, then the defender; neither becomes the occupier because of the withdrawal.

## Retreat

- follows a battle loss;
- the battle has a winner and loser;
- win, loss, retreat, Occupation, and other result effects apply.

## Withdrawal

- ends or prevents a pending or active battle without a winner;
- win, loss, and retreat effects do not occur;
- before Onset: no battle or Aftermath occurs;
- after Onset: complete the remaining non-result steps of the Aftermath and clear any committed battle cards using their normal destinations.

**Fall Back** is ordinary Movement. It is neither retreat nor withdrawal.

## Front Line

Your **Front Line** is the unbroken sequence of Territories you control from your own end.

- Control cannot skip an opposing Territory.
- Your token may move beyond your Front Line.
- During Capture, add the next opposing Territory immediately beyond your Front Line if your token is on or beyond it.
- The captured Territory may be behind your token.
- Deep Position alone does not capture the final Territory. Last Stand access instead requires a new legal Advance beyond the opponent's end after that opponent is beyond the Gauntlet.

## Core Vocabulary

| Term            | Meaning                                                                          |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Opening         | Action phase before Movement.                                                    |
| Denouement      | Action phase after Movement and any resulting battle.                            |
| Faction Action  | Faction-specific option chosen when taking an Action; lists its legal phase.     |
| Faction Ability | Faction-specific effect at its own timing; does not use an Action unless stated. |
| Fall Back       | Ordinary Movement one position toward your own end.                              |
| Pending battle  | Pre-battle state before Onset.                                                   |
| Onset           | Opening stage of an active battle.                                               |
| Aftermath       | Closing stage of an active battle.                                               |
| Defensive Edge  | Conditional benefit that causes the defender to win tied battle totals.          |
| Tiebreak Roll   | Separate unmodified one-die sudden-death roll.                                   |
| Front Line      | Contiguous controlled Territories from your own end.                             |
| Retreat         | Displacement after losing a battle.                                              |
| Withdraw        | Leave or prevent a battle without determining a winner.                          |